THE AI RISK MAP · ANATOMY OF ONE SCENARIO

Loss of control over advanced AI

The most argued-over scenario on the map, broken down the way all eighteen are: both sides' case, every published number, what they already agree on, and the sorting test.

THE WORRIED CASE

Nobody can yet reliably give an AI the goals we intend, or fully read the goals it ends up with.

Once systems out-plan us, a mismatch could become impossible to correct, and the downside cannot be undone.

Eliezer Yudkowsky and Nate Soares (2025). Geoffrey Hinton (2024).

THE SKEPTICAL CASE

Being intelligent does not imply wanting to dominate. Safety is an engineering problem, like early jet engines.

Deployment stays gradual, which gives societies time to notice and fix problems, as with every past technology.

Yann LeCun (2023). Arvind Narayanan and Sayash Kapoor (2025).

HOW FAR APART THE PUBLISHED ESTIMATES ARE

Each dot is a published median. The scale is logarithmic because the estimates span more than a hundredfold, and months of structured debate barely moved anyone. The map never adds a number of its own.



WHAT BOTH CAMPS ALREADY AGREE ON

From a November 2025 joint essay by the authors of the two best-known opposing forecasts, "AI 2027" and "AI as Normal Technology."

- AI should not autonomously control critical systems.
- Developers should be transparent and independently audited.
- Governments need real technical capacity to track AI.
- No unmonitored AI rebuilding itself.

THE SORTING TEST

STEP 1
Already covered by law?
NO

→

STEP 2
An action both sides accept?
YES, THE LIST ABOVE

→

Policy: act now

The safeguards don't depend on settling who is right about the odds. That is the point of the map: find the actions both sides can live with.

Idea: Emad Mostaque, Moonshots with Peter Diamandis, 7 October 2026, at 49:14.

Full map with every source: **ai-risk-map.vercel.app**

Working draft, October 2026. 0 of 18 scenarios signed off by both sides so far.